Books to gather

Borrow physical copies or authorized editions; exact page numbers depend on the edition.

Room on the Broom

Julia Donaldson | Picture-book fiction

Prepare: one copy of Room on the Broom; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket

Big Pumpkin

Erica Silverman | Picture-book fiction

Prepare: one copy of Big Pumpkin; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket

Pumpkin Soup

Helen Cooper | Picture-book fiction

Prepare: one copy of Pumpkin Soup; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket

Too Many Pumpkins

Linda White | Picture-book fiction

Prepare: one copy of Too Many Pumpkins; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket

The Pumpkin Book

Gail Gibbons | Informational picture book

Prepare: one copy of The Pumpkin Book; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket

A Chair for My Mother

Vera B. Williams | Realistic fiction

Prepare: one copy of A Chair for My Mother; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket

Action Jackson

Jan Greenberg and Sandra Jordan; illustrated by Robert Andrew Parker | Informational picture-book biography

Prepare: one copy of Action Jackson; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket

Seasonal books and investigations

Stacie's books are the teaching texts, with hands-on access to the grade-level skills.

Week 1 | Room on the Broom

Julia Donaldson | witch, cat, dog, bird and frog props; pretend broom

Grade 3: Name a character and show how an animal helps the witch. Grade 4: Show how the animals work together to help the witch. Point to an illustration that supports your answer.

Week 2 | Big Pumpkin

Julia Donaldson | witch, cat, dog, bird and frog props; pretend broom

Grade 3: Name a character and show how an animal helps the witch. Grade 4: Show how the animals work together to help the witch. Point to an illustration that supports your answer.

Week 3 | Pumpkin Soup

Erica Silverman | pumpkin photo or small pumpkin; character cards; ribbon

Grade 3: Identify who tries to pull the pumpkin and sequence two attempts. Grade 4: Explain how the bat's idea helps the group solve the problem. Show an illustration that supports the solution.

Week 4 | Too Many Pumpkins

Helen Cooper | cat, squirrel and duck props; bowl and spoon

Grade 3: Sequence the problem and the friends' response. Grade 4: Explain how the friends' actions affect one another. Use an illustration to explain how the problem is resolved.

Week 5 | The Pumpkin Book

Linda White | pumpkin photos; garden mat; baskets

Grade 3: Show what changes for Rebecca Estelle during the story. Grade 4: Explain how her response to the pumpkins changes. Point to a scene that supports a message about sharing.

Week 6 | A Chair for My Mother

Linda White | pumpkin photos; garden mat; baskets

Grade 3: Show what changes for Rebecca Estelle during the story. Grade 4: Explain how her response to the pumpkins changes. Point to a scene that supports a message about sharing.

Informational reading

The Pumpkin Book by Gail Gibbons replaces the former flag book in weeks 1-2. Identify the central idea, find a real growth fact and connect the fact to the idea. Keep this informational strand alongside Room on the Broom.

2026-10-23 | Science investigation

Pumpkin push investigation: use a lightweight pumpkin model on a tray. Grade 3 predicts and compares a push and pull (3.7B). Grade 4 rolls a toy car into the stationary model and observes energy transfer (4.8A). Repeat three trials with the same surface. Save one prediction, observation and explanation per learner.

2026-11-06 | Science investigation

Pumpkin sound investigation: shake an adult-sealed container of dried pumpkin seeds softly. Grade 3 identifies sound energy (3.8A). Grade 4 compares sound on/off beside a light paper membrane to look for vibration as evidence of sound energy transfer (4.8A). If no movement is visible, record that result and use the teacher's tested sound demonstration.

2026-11-20 | Science investigation

Leaf-and-ramp investigation: first observe and sort collected leaves by visible features as ungraded exploration. Test the same toy car on a bare ramp and a securely fixed dry-leaf surface. Grade 3 compares speed and the distance a foam block moves after contact (3.8B); Grade 4 describes the friction pattern (4.7). Keep car, release point and ramp height constant; repeat three trials. Do not infer energy from leaf color. Grade 3 uses the same car and foam block for slow/faster trials, resets the block each time and compares the effects. Grade 4 changes only the track surface for the friction comparison.

2026-12-11 | Science investigation

Design-and-test lab: reuse the familiar ramp setup. Grade 3 demonstrates a motion/energy finding (3.8B). Grade 4 tests smooth and textured surfaces for a friction pattern (4.7). Make one planned change, repeat three times, and use a photo or model to explain the evidence. Grade 3 uses the same car and foam block for slow/faster trials, resets the block each time and compares the effects. Grade 4 changes only the track surface for the friction comparison.

Access and evidence

Props, pictures and AAC support the response. Return to the actual book or investigation evidence. Record accuracy and prompts separately; use three observations on lab Fridays.

Week 1 | Real-book guide

October 13 to 16 | Helpers solve a problem by sharing what they have.

One book, all subjects

Room on the Broom | Helpers solve a problem by sharing what they have. Math: Count and share "broom supplies" into equal groups; name the total or amount in each group. Science: Use broom, wagon and character props to test a push or pull and describe the change in motion. Social studies: Name how each helper contributes and connect the story to responsible classroom citizenship. Finish: Make a helper collage or build a paper broom with labeled passengers.

Grade 3 | Room on the Broom

Julia Donaldson | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

one copy of Room on the Broom; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from Room on the Broom to teach both learners. The Grade 3 and Grade 4 targets are different, but the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are the same.

2026-10-13: Explain how a character's action changes what happens next. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-10-14: Answer a who, what, where, when, why or how question about the story. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-10-15: Identify what happens at the beginning, middle and end of the story. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-10-16: Identify the story problem and the action a character takes. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Grade 4 | Room on the Broom

Julia Donaldson | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

one copy of Room on the Broom; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from Room on the Broom to teach both learners. The Grade 3 and Grade 4 targets are different, but the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are the same.

2026-10-13: Use a detail from the story to explain a character's choice. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-10-14: Answer a why or how question and cite the illustration or page that supports it. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-10-15: Explain the story problem, important action and resolution using page evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-10-16: Explain how two characters interact and how that affects the plot. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Book access

Borrow a physical book or authorized library/publisher edition. These guides contain teaching prompts, not reproductions of the books. HMH supplies the grade-level reading, writing, drama and spelling selections.

Week 2 | Real-book guide

October 19 to 23 | A difficult problem changes when everyone works together.

One book, all subjects

Big Pumpkin | A difficult problem changes when everyone works together. Math: Share pumpkin counters or seeds into equal groups and represent the groups with the week's operation. Science: Use a toy pumpkin or car to show how a push or pull changes position and motion. Social studies: Match each character to a team role and explain how cooperation helps the group. Finish: Create a lift-the-pumpkin paper chain showing each helper in order.

Grade 3 | Big Pumpkin

Erica Silverman | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

one copy of Big Pumpkin; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from Big Pumpkin to teach both learners. The Grade 3 and Grade 4 targets are different, but the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are the same.

2026-10-19: Answer a who, what, where, when, why or how question about the story. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-10-20: Identify what happens at the beginning, middle and end of the story. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-10-21: Identify the story problem and the action a character takes. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-10-22: Retell the important events in order using three picture cards. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-10-23: Explain how a character's action changes what happens next. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Grade 4 | Big Pumpkin

Erica Silverman | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

one copy of Big Pumpkin; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from Big Pumpkin to teach both learners. The Grade 3 and Grade 4 targets are different, but the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are the same.

2026-10-19: Answer a why or how question and cite the illustration or page that supports it. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-10-20: Explain the story problem, important action and resolution using page evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-10-21: Explain how two characters interact and how that affects the plot. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-10-22: Analyze the sequence of events and identify the turning point. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-10-23: Use a detail from the story to explain a character's choice. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Book access

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Week 3 | Real-book guide

October 26 to 30 | Everyone contributes a job so a shared plan can work.

One book, all subjects

Pumpkin Soup | Everyone contributes a job so a shared plan can work. Math: Use pretend soup ingredients to make equal groups or a simple input-output table for servings. Science: Connect stirring, scooping and warming to the week's energy target and record what the action changes. Social studies: Practice taking turns, sharing jobs and repairing a disagreement in a classroom community. Finish: Make a paper soup bowl with picture ingredients and a three-part problem/solution strip.

Grade 3 | Pumpkin Soup

Helen Cooper | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

one copy of Pumpkin Soup; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from Pumpkin Soup to teach both learners. The Grade 3 and Grade 4 targets are different, but the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are the same.

2026-10-26: Identify the story problem and the action a character takes. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-10-27: Retell the important events in order using three picture cards. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-10-28: Explain how a character's action changes what happens next. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-10-29: Answer a who, what, where, when, why or how question about the story. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-10-30: Identify what happens at the beginning, middle and end of the story. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Grade 4 | Pumpkin Soup

Helen Cooper | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

one copy of Pumpkin Soup; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from Pumpkin Soup to teach both learners. The Grade 3 and Grade 4 targets are different, but the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are the same.

2026-10-26: Explain how two characters interact and how that affects the plot. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-10-27: Analyze the sequence of events and identify the turning point. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-10-28: Use a detail from the story to explain a character's choice. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-10-29: Answer a why or how question and cite the illustration or page that supports it. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-10-30: Explain the story problem, important action and resolution using page evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Book access

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Week 4 | Real-book guide

November 2 to 6 | A surprising problem can become a useful resource for the community.

One book, all subjects

Too Many Pumpkins | A surprising problem can become a useful resource for the community. Math: Measure, sort or partition pumpkin models and record the week's table or fraction relationship. Science: Make a safe pumpkin sound or vibration investigation and identify the evidence the sound produces. Social studies: Compare the character's original response with the later community action and explain the change. Finish: Build a pumpkin-to-community flow map: problem, idea, helping action, result.

Grade 3 | Too Many Pumpkins

Linda White | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

one copy of Too Many Pumpkins; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from Too Many Pumpkins to teach both learners. The Grade 3 and Grade 4 targets are different, but the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are the same.

2026-11-04: Answer a who, what, where, when, why or how question about the story. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-11-05: Identify what happens at the beginning, middle and end of the story. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-11-06: Identify the story problem and the action a character takes. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Grade 4 | Too Many Pumpkins

Linda White | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

one copy of Too Many Pumpkins; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from Too Many Pumpkins to teach both learners. The Grade 3 and Grade 4 targets are different, but the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are the same.

2026-11-04: Answer a why or how question and cite the illustration or page that supports it. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-11-05: Explain the story problem, important action and resolution using page evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-11-06: Explain how two characters interact and how that affects the plot. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Book access

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Week 5 | Real-book guide

November 9 to 13 | Information helps us understand a living thing and make careful observations.

One book, all subjects

The Pumpkin Book | Information helps us understand a living thing and make careful observations. Math: Partition a pumpkin model into equal parts and build or name the week's fractions with picture pieces. Science: Observe and label pumpkin parts or growth stages, then connect each observation to the information page. Social studies: Compare two simple sources about pumpkins and name which detail each source contributes. Finish: Make a large-print pumpkin life-cycle accordion book with picture labels and one fact per panel.

Grade 3 | The Pumpkin Book

Gail Gibbons | Informational picture book

Prepare

one copy of The Pumpkin Book; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from The Pumpkin Book to teach both learners. The Grade 3 and Grade 4 targets are different, but the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are the same.

2026-11-09: Use one page detail to explain what the book teaches. (TEKS 3.9D(i))

2026-11-10: Identify the central idea and one detail about how pumpkins grow. (TEKS 3.9D(i))

2026-11-11: Put the information about pumpkin growth in order and retell it. (TEKS 3.9D(i))

2026-11-12: Choose two details that support the central idea. (TEKS 3.9D(i))

2026-11-13: Answer a who, what, where, when, why or how question about the information. (TEKS 3.9D(i))

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Grade 4 | The Pumpkin Book

Gail Gibbons | Informational picture book

Prepare

one copy of The Pumpkin Book; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from The Pumpkin Book to teach both learners. The Grade 3 and Grade 4 targets are different, but the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are the same.

2026-11-09: Compare two details and explain how they support the central idea. (TEKS 4.9D(i), 4.7C)

2026-11-10: State the central idea and support it with two details from the book. (TEKS 4.9D(i), 4.7C)

2026-11-11: Organize information from two pages under the same central idea. (TEKS 4.9D(i), 4.7C)

2026-11-12: Explain how a text feature or illustration supports the information. (TEKS 4.9D(i), 4.7C)

2026-11-13: Answer a why or how question using evidence from the book. (TEKS 4.9D(i), 4.7C)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Book access

Borrow a physical book or authorized library/publisher edition. These guides contain teaching prompts, not reproductions of the books. HMH supplies the grade-level reading, writing, drama and spelling selections.

Week 6 | Real-book guide

November 16 to 20 | Small contributions build toward a shared goal after a hard event.

One book, all subjects

A Chair for My Mother | Small contributions build toward a shared goal after a hard event. Math: Use coins, counters or measurement strips to model repeated contributions toward a goal. Science: Test a small chair or cart on ramps and surfaces; describe how the energy or speed changes. Social studies: Identify family, neighbor and community support and explain how each action helps. Finish: Create a goal jar with picture contributions and a beginning-middle-end celebration scene.

Grade 3 | A Chair for My Mother

Vera B. Williams | Realistic fiction

Prepare

one copy of A Chair for My Mother; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from A Chair for My Mother to teach both learners. The Grade 3 and Grade 4 targets are different, but the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are the same.

2026-11-16: Identify the story problem and the action a character takes. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-11-17: Retell the important events in order using three picture cards. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-11-18: Explain how a character's action changes what happens next. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-11-19: Answer a who, what, where, when, why or how question about the story. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-11-20: Identify what happens at the beginning, middle and end of the story. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Grade 4 | A Chair for My Mother

Vera B. Williams | Realistic fiction

Prepare

one copy of A Chair for My Mother; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from A Chair for My Mother to teach both learners. The Grade 3 and Grade 4 targets are different, but the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are the same.

2026-11-16: Explain how two characters interact and how that affects the plot. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-11-17: Analyze the sequence of events and identify the turning point. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-11-18: Use a detail from the story to explain a character's choice. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-11-19: Answer a why or how question and cite the illustration or page that supports it. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-11-20: Explain the story problem, important action and resolution using page evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Book access

Borrow a physical book or authorized library/publisher edition. These guides contain teaching prompts, not reproductions of the books. HMH supplies the grade-level reading, writing, drama and spelling selections.

Week 7 | Real-book guide

November 30 to December 4 | An artist turns observation, materials and choices into a message.

One book, all subjects

Action Jackson | An artist turns observation, materials and choices into a message. Math: Use the artwork's shapes, areas or equal parts to model the week's fraction or measurement target. Science: Test how light, color or material choices change what viewers observe and record the evidence. Social studies: Connect an artist's work to a community, place or shared story and explain how creators contribute. Finish: Make a texture-and-color collage inspired by the book, with a dictated or written artist statement.

Grade 3 | Action Jackson

Jan Greenberg and Sandra Jordan; illustrated by Robert Andrew Parker | Informational picture-book biography

Prepare

one copy of Action Jackson; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from Action Jackson to teach both learners. The Grade 3 and Grade 4 targets are different, but the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are the same.

2026-11-30: Identify what happens at the beginning, middle and end of the story. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-12-01: Identify the story problem and the action a character takes. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-12-02: Retell the important events in order using three picture cards. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-12-03: Explain how a character's action changes what happens next. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-12-04: Answer a who, what, where, when, why or how question about the story. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Grade 4 | Action Jackson

Jan Greenberg and Sandra Jordan; illustrated by Robert Andrew Parker | Informational picture-book biography

Prepare

one copy of Action Jackson; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from Action Jackson to teach both learners. The Grade 3 and Grade 4 targets are different, but the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are the same.

2026-11-30: Explain the story problem, important action and resolution using page evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-12-01: Explain how two characters interact and how that affects the plot. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-12-02: Analyze the sequence of events and identify the turning point. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-12-03: Use a detail from the story to explain a character's choice. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-12-04: Answer a why or how question and cite the illustration or page that supports it. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Book access

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Week 8 | Real-book guide

December 7 to 11 | A team uses evidence from a journey to improve its plan.

One book, all subjects

Room on the Broom | A team uses evidence from a journey to improve its plan. Math: Measure or compare broom-route lengths and use the week's fraction comparison with visual strips. Science: Test broom or car materials for friction and revise the design after observing the results. Social studies: Map the helpers' route and explain how people work together to solve a community problem. Finish: Design a safer, stronger broom or route map and label the evidence behind each choice.

Grade 3 | Room on the Broom

Julia Donaldson | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

one copy of Room on the Broom; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from Room on the Broom to teach both learners. The Grade 3 and Grade 4 targets are different, but the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are the same.

2026-12-07: Retell the important events in order using three picture cards. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-12-08: Explain how a character's action changes what happens next. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-12-09: Answer a who, what, where, when, why or how question about the story. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-12-10: Identify what happens at the beginning, middle and end of the story. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-12-11: Identify the story problem and the action a character takes. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Grade 4 | Room on the Broom

Julia Donaldson | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

one copy of Room on the Broom; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from Room on the Broom to teach both learners. The Grade 3 and Grade 4 targets are different, but the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are the same.

2026-12-07: Analyze the sequence of events and identify the turning point. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-12-08: Use a detail from the story to explain a character's choice. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-12-09: Answer a why or how question and cite the illustration or page that supports it. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-12-10: Explain the story problem, important action and resolution using page evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-12-11: Explain how two characters interact and how that affects the plot. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Book access

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Week 9 | Real-book guide

December 14 to 18 | Shared work turns a stubborn problem into a result everyone can explain.

One book, all subjects

Big Pumpkin | Shared work turns a stubborn problem into a result everyone can explain. Math: Measure and share pumpkin models, then show the final week's fraction or capacity reasoning. Science: Choose one energy or motion idea from the story setting, test it, and explain the observed evidence. Social studies: Present a problem, a group action and the result using the story's shared-work structure. Finish: Create a learning-gallery display with a pumpkin problem/solution sequence and one evidence card.

Grade 3 | Big Pumpkin

Erica Silverman | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

one copy of Big Pumpkin; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from Big Pumpkin to teach both learners. The Grade 3 and Grade 4 targets are different, but the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are the same.

2026-12-14: Answer a who, what, where, when, why or how question about the story. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-12-15: Identify what happens at the beginning, middle and end of the story. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-12-16: Identify the story problem and the action a character takes. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-12-17: Retell the important events in order using three picture cards. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-12-18: Explain how a character's action changes what happens next. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Grade 4 | Big Pumpkin

Erica Silverman | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

one copy of Big Pumpkin; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from Big Pumpkin to teach both learners. The Grade 3 and Grade 4 targets are different, but the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are the same.

2026-12-14: Answer a why or how question and cite the illustration or page that supports it. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-12-15: Explain the story problem, important action and resolution using page evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-12-16: Explain how two characters interact and how that affects the plot. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-12-17: Analyze the sequence of events and identify the turning point. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-12-18: Use a detail from the story to explain a character's choice. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Book access

Borrow a physical book or authorized library/publisher edition. These guides contain teaching prompts, not reproductions of the books. HMH supplies the grade-level reading, writing, drama and spelling selections.

Reading response and story mats

Teacher-created, large-print companion for one shared read-aloud. Add real book illustrations, objects or the student's existing symbols.

Ask the same story-structure WH questions for both learners: Who? What? Where? When? Why? How? Keep the book open and return to the page or illustration for evidence.

Who and where?

Character / topic: _____ Setting: _____ Picture, prop or page evidence: _____

Beginning

What happened first? _____ I can show it by pointing, using AAC, telling, dictating or writing:

_____

_____

Middle

What problem or important event happened next? _____

_____

_____

End

How did it end or change? _____

_____

_____

Why and how?

Why did the character act? _____ How do you know? Page / picture: _____

_____

First, next, then

Use for a taught sequence. Add real photos, props or symbols.

FIRST: draw, place or paste	NEXT: draw, place or paste	THEN: draw, place or paste

My response

The story was about _____ My favorite part was _____ Large-print writing / dictation / AAC response:

_____

_____

_____

Independent routine

First: familiar task _____ Then: finished basket / planned break _____ Help signal _____ Finish after ____ items.

Writing and source-evidence frames

Use the actual book, photo, map or history source. A frame supports composition; it is not an answer key.

Reading response | 3.7B

In _____, I learned / noticed _____. The page shows _____.

Compare sources | 4.7B

Both _____ and _____ show _____. They differ because _____. My evidence is _____.

Story message

The topic is _____. The message is _____. The character's action _____ supports it.

History claim | 3.14F

My claim: _____. Source title / creator / date: _____. This detail supports it: _____.

Texas history

Person / event: _____. What happened: _____. A cause or effect: _____. Source evidence: _____.

Teacher record

Response method: _____. Planned access: _____. Extra prompt: _____. Next step: _____.

Equal groups and sharing mat

Math: 3.4D, 3.4E, 3.4H, 3.4J; supported division models for 4.4E.

Make equal groups to multiply, or share the total equally to divide. Tell whether the unknown is the number of groups or the number in each group.

Group 1	Group 2	Group 3

Connect model and equation

____ groups of ____ = ____ total. ____ divided by ____ = ____. Related multiplication fact: _____

Fresh response

New total / groups: _____ Student response: _____ Extra help: _____

Equal-length fraction strips

Math: 3.3A/C/D/F/G/H and 4.3A/B/C/D/E

Each row is the same-size whole. Print at actual size. Cut individual parts only after comparing equal whole lengths.

Whole	1						
2 equal parts	1/2	1/2					
3 equal parts	1/3	1/3	1/3				
4 equal parts	1/4	1/4	1/4	1/4			
6 equal parts	1/6	1/6	1/6	1/6	1/6	1/6	
8 equal parts	1/8	1/8	1/8	1/8	1/8	1/8	1/8	1/8

Build, compare, explain

Build 3/4 from unit fractions. Compare 1/2 with 2/4, then 1/2 with 3/4. Record an equation or comparison and show why it is true.

Array, area and perimeter mat

Math: 3.4D/E; 4.5C/D

Use each square as one square unit. Outline a 2-by-3 rectangle. Count tiles inside for area and unit edges around it for perimeter.

Connect the formulas

Area: ____ rows x ____ columns = ____ square units. Perimeter: ____ + ____ + ____ + ____ = ____ units.
Explain how your model supports the formula: _____

Science investigation record

Student _____ Date _____ TEKS _____

Our question

What will we test? _____

Plan and predict

I think _____ because _____. What stays the same? _____ What changes? _____

Observe three trials

Trial 1: _____ Trial 2: _____ Trial 3: _____

Explain with evidence

I observed _____. This supports _____ because _____.

Energy investigation

Same car and block; slow/faster runs. Record observed speed and effect on the block. Reset and repeat.

Mixture investigation

Mass before: ____ Mass after: ____ Same closed container, no spills. What do these readings show?

Teacher evidence

Correct / total: ____ Extra prompts: ____ Response method: ____ Next step: ____

Choose this week's licensed lessons

Week ____ Grade 3 learner _____ Grade 4 learner _____

Start with the calendar's daily target. Select the matching lesson inside the licensed account; no publisher lesson numbers or student placement are assumed.

Resource and role	Grade 3 lesson / target	Grade 4 lesson / target
HMH: reading and writing	_____ _____	_____ _____
HMH: assessed spelling pattern / exact TEKS	_____ _____	_____ _____
STEMscopes: paced math skill	_____ _____	_____ _____
McGraw Hill: science concept	_____ _____	_____ _____
Bridges: placement-selected intervention	_____ _____	_____ _____
Vizzle: already-taught independent practice	_____ _____	_____ _____

Three taught spelling words per learner

Grade 3: _____ _____ _____ Grade 4: _____ _____ _____

Our nine weeks of learning

October 13-December 18, 2026 | Family overview

We will learn through real books, objects, models and short investigations. Students can show learning by speaking, pointing, arranging pictures, using AAC or writing. We keep a predictable daily routine.

Week 1 | October 13 to 16

Helpers solve a problem by sharing what they have. | Books: Room on the Broom | Story focus: Notice the problem, the helper's action, and what changes next.

Book-centered connections: Math - Count and share "broom supplies" into equal groups; name the total or amount in each group. Science - Use broom, wagon and character props to test a push or pull and describe the change in motion. Social studies - Name how each helper contributes and connect the story to responsible classroom citizenship. Enrichment - Make a helper collage or build a paper broom with labeled passengers.

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Retell beginning, middle and end and answer story WH questions. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D). Grade 4 - Explain plot, character actions and story evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C).

Math: Grade 3 - Make equal groups and find the total; then Share equally and find how many are in each group. (TEKS 3.4D, 3.4E, 3.4H, 3.4J). Grade 4 - Model division and connect the model to an equation. (TEKS 4.4E, 4.4F).

Science: Grade 3 - Show how a push or pull changes motion. (TEKS 3.7A, 3.7B). Grade 4 - Compare mixtures and show that the materials are still present. (TEKS 4.6B, 4.6C).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Recognize responsible citizenship and explain how people help their community. (TEKS 3.9C, 3.9A). Grade 4 - Identify why people explored Texas and connect an explorer to a route, goal, or result. (TEKS 4.2B, 4.2A).

Week 2 | October 19 to 23

A difficult problem changes when everyone works together. | Books: Big Pumpkin | Story focus: Sequence the stuck-pumpkin problem, the group's attempts, and the shared solution.

Book-centered connections: Math - Share pumpkin counters or seeds into equal groups and represent the groups with the week's operation. Science - Use a toy pumpkin or car to show how a push or pull changes position and motion. Social studies - Match each character to a team role and explain how cooperation helps the group. Enrichment - Create a lift-the-pumpkin paper chain showing each helper in order.

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Retell beginning, middle and end and answer story WH questions. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D). Grade 4 - Explain plot, character actions and story evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C).

Math: Grade 3 - Share equally and find how many are in each group. (TEKS 3.4H, 3.4J). Grade 4 - Represent a two-step problem with operations, a diagram and a letter for the unknown. (TEKS 4.5A).

Science: Grade 3 - Show how a push or pull changes motion. (TEKS 3.7A, 3.7B). Grade 4 - Observe energy moving from one object to another. (TEKS 4.8A).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Recognize responsible citizenship and explain how people help their community. (TEKS 3.9A, 3.9C). Grade 4 - Connect motivations for exploration to specific explorers and outcomes. (TEKS 4.2A, 4.2B).

Week 3 | October 26 to 30

Everyone contributes a job so a shared plan can work. | Books: Pumpkin Soup | Story focus: Identify the characters' jobs, the conflict about changing roles, and the repaired plan.

Book-centered connections: Math - Use pretend soup ingredients to make equal groups or a simple input-output table for servings. Science - Connect stirring, scooping and warming to the week's energy target and record what the action changes. Social studies - Practice taking turns, sharing jobs and repairing a disagreement in a classroom community. Enrichment - Make a paper soup bowl with picture ingredients and a three-part problem/solution strip.

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Retell beginning, middle and end and answer story WH questions. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D). Grade 4 - Explain plot, character actions and story evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C).

Math: Grade 3 - Share equally and find how many are in each group; then Show how two quantities change together in a table. (TEKS 3.4H, 3.4J, 3.5E). Grade 4 - Represent a two-step problem with operations, a diagram and a letter for the unknown; then Measure the space inside a rectangle and the distance around it. (TEKS 4.5A, 4.5C, 4.5D).

Science: Grade 3 - Identify light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. (TEKS 3.8A). Grade 4 - Observe energy transfer, test materials and build a closed circuit. (TEKS 4.8A, 4.8B, 4.8C).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Recognize responsible citizenship and explain how people help their community. (TEKS 3.9A, 3.9C). Grade 4 - Summarize why exploration occurred and connect explorers to outcomes. (TEKS 4.2A, 4.2B).

Week 4 | November 2 to 6

A surprising problem can become a useful resource for the community. | Books: Too Many Pumpkins | Story focus: Use illustrations and details to show how the pumpkin problem becomes a plan that helps others.

Book-centered connections: Math - Measure, sort or partition pumpkin models and record the week's table or fraction relationship. Science - Make a safe pumpkin sound or vibration investigation and identify the evidence the sound produces. Social studies - Compare the character's original response with the later community action and explain the change. Enrichment - Build a pumpkin-to-community flow map: problem, idea, helping action, result.

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Retell beginning, middle and end and answer story WH questions. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D). Grade 4 - Explain plot, character actions and story evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C).

Math: Grade 3 - Show how two quantities change together in a table; then Name equal parts of a whole and show a fraction. (TEKS 3.5E, 3.3A, 3.3C). Grade 4 - Measure the space inside a rectangle and the distance around it. (TEKS 4.5C, 4.5D).

Science: Grade 3 - Identify light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. (TEKS 3.8A). Grade 4 - Observe how sound transfers energy. (TEKS 4.8A).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Tell the difference between kinds of sources and use a source to learn about the past. (TEKS 3.14B, 3.14F). Grade 4 - Identify a major Texas Revolution event and place it in a simple cause/event/result sequence. (TEKS 4.3B, 4.3A).

Week 5 | November 9 to 13

Information helps us understand a living thing and make careful observations. | Books: The Pumpkin Book | Story focus: Sort facts, illustrations and text features into a central idea with supporting details.

Book-centered connections: Math - Partition a pumpkin model into equal parts and build or name the week's fractions with picture pieces. Science - Observe and label pumpkin parts or growth stages, then connect each observation to the information page. Social studies - Compare two simple sources about pumpkins and name which detail each source contributes. Enrichment - Make a large-print pumpkin life-cycle accordion book with picture labels and one fact per panel.

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Find the central idea and supporting details. (TEKS 3.9D(i)). Grade 4 - Explain the central idea with evidence from the information book. (TEKS 4.9D(i), 4.7C).

Math: Grade 3 - Name equal parts of a whole and show a fraction; then Build and take apart fractions using unit fractions. (TEKS 3.3A, 3.3C, 3.3D). Grade 4 - Use a rule to complete an input-output table. (TEKS 4.5B).

Science: Grade 3 - Identify light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. (TEKS 3.8A). Grade 4 - Observe energy transfer, test materials and build a closed circuit; then Test a pattern in gravity, friction or magnetism. (TEKS 4.8A, 4.8B, 4.8C, 4.7).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Compare information from two simple sources about the same topic. (TEKS 3.14A, 3.14B, 3.14F). Grade 4 - Identify major events/people of the Texas Revolution and connect actions to outcomes. (TEKS 4.3A, 4.3B).

Week 6 | November 16 to 20

Small contributions build toward a shared goal after a hard event. | Books: A Chair for My Mother | Story focus: Sequence the family's problem, saving actions and the result they celebrate together.

Book-centered connections: Math - Use coins, counters or measurement strips to model repeated contributions toward a goal. Science - Test a small chair or cart on ramps and surfaces; describe how the energy or speed changes. Social studies - Identify family, neighbor and community support and explain how each action helps. Enrichment - Create a goal jar with picture contributions and a beginning-middle-end celebration scene.

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Retell beginning, middle and end and answer story WH questions. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D). Grade 4 - Explain plot, character actions and story evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C).

Math: Grade 3 - Build and take apart fractions using unit fractions. (TEKS 3.3C, 3.3D). Grade 4 - Use equal-size wholes to compare fractions and explain why. (TEKS 4.3C, 4.3D).

Science: Grade 3 - Identify everyday forms of energy; then Test how speed relates to mechanical energy. (TEKS 3.8A, 3.8B). Grade 4 - Test a pattern in gravity, friction or magnetism. (TEKS 4.7).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Use historical sources to support one claim about the past. (TEKS 3.14A, 3.14B, 3.14F). Grade 4 - Place major events/people in order and explain one cause/effect relationship. (TEKS 4.3A, 4.3B).

Week 7 | November 30 to December 4

An artist turns observation, materials and choices into a message. | Books: Action Jackson | Story focus: Track what the artist notices, chooses and changes while creating the painting.

Book-centered connections: Math - Use the artwork's shapes, areas or equal parts to model the week's fraction or measurement target. Science - Test how light, color or material choices change what viewers observe and record the evidence. Social studies - Connect an artist's work to a community, place or shared story and explain how creators contribute. Enrichment - Make a texture-and-color collage inspired by the book, with a dictated or written artist statement.

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Retell beginning, middle and end and answer story WH questions. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D). Grade 4 - Explain plot, character actions and story evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C).

Math: Grade 3 - Show that different fractions can name the same amount. (TEKS 3.3F, 3.3G). Grade 4 - Use equal-size wholes to compare fractions and explain why. (TEKS 4.3C, 4.3D).

Science: Grade 3 - Test how speed relates to mechanical energy. (TEKS 3.8B). Grade 4 - Test a pattern in gravity, friction or magnetism. (TEKS 4.7).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Explain how people's actions can improve a community and identify a community need/solution. (TEKS 3.1A, 3.9C, 3.2B). Grade 4 - Identify key leaders/events of the Republic of Texas and explain movement toward statehood/annexation. (TEKS 4.3C, 4.3D, 4.3E).

Week 8 | December 7 to 11

A team uses evidence from a journey to improve its plan. | Books: Room on the Broom | Story focus: Compare the broom's problem, the evidence from each scene, and the improved solution.

Book-centered connections: Math - Measure or compare broom-route lengths and use the week's fraction comparison with visual strips. Science - Test broom or car materials for friction and revise the design after observing the results. Social studies - Map the helpers' route and explain how people work together to solve a community problem. Enrichment - Design a safer, stronger broom or route map and label the evidence behind each choice.

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Retell beginning, middle and end and answer story WH questions. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D). Grade 4 - Explain plot, character actions and story evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C).

Math: Grade 3 - Show that different fractions can name the same amount; then Compare fractions with the same numerator or denominator. (TEKS 3.3F, 3.3G, 3.3H). Grade 4 - Join or remove fractional parts with the same denominator. (TEKS 4.3A, 4.3B, 4.3E).

Science: Grade 3 - Test how speed relates to mechanical energy; then Demonstrate an energy idea and explain the observed evidence. (TEKS 3.8B, 3.8A). Grade 4 - Test a pattern in gravity, friction or magnetism. (TEKS 4.7).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Identify a community problem and explain how people can work together to improve it. (TEKS 3.1A, 3.9C, 3.2B). Grade 4 - Explain one challenge/success of the Republic of Texas and connect events to annexation/statehood. (TEKS 4.3C, 4.3D, 4.3E).

Week 9 | December 14 to 18

Shared work turns a stubborn problem into a result everyone can explain. | Books: Big Pumpkin | Story focus: Retell the complete problem-action-result chain and support it with a page or picture.

Book-centered connections: Math - Measure and share pumpkin models, then show the final week's fraction or capacity reasoning. Science - Choose one energy or motion idea from the story setting, test it, and explain the observed evidence. Social studies - Present a problem, a group action and the result using the story's shared-work structure. Enrichment - Create a learning-gallery display with a pumpkin problem/solution sequence and one evidence card.

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Retell beginning, middle and end and answer story WH questions. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D). Grade 4 - Explain plot, character actions and story evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C).

Math: Grade 3 - Compare fractions with the same numerator or denominator; then Choose a tool and measure weight or how much a container holds. (TEKS 3.3H, 3.7D, 3.7E). Grade 4 - Join or remove fractional parts with the same denominator. (TEKS 4.3A, 4.3B, 4.3E).

Science: Grade 3 - Demonstrate an energy idea and explain the observed evidence. (TEKS 3.8A, 3.8B). Grade 4 - Use a tested model to explain a force or energy transfer. (TEKS 4.7, 4.8A).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Show how an individual/group can improve a community using a problem to action to result explanation. (TEKS 3.1A, 3.9C, 3.2B). Grade 4 - Summarize one Republic/statehood event or leader and place it in the larger sequence. (TEKS 4.3C, 4.3D, 4.3E).

Friday routine

Each Friday: short spelling, reading, math and science checks. Science experiments: October 23, November 6, November 20 and December 11. The experiment provides the science check evidence. November 23-27 is fall break in this plan.

Individual learning outline

Student: _____ Current learning step: _____ Successful response mode: _____ Helpful supports: _____ Next challenge: _____ Family note: _____. IEP goals will be added after Stacie provides them.